it seemed well worthwhile to chance it, so he fell groaning with considerable spirit. But Sid slept on unconscious. Tom groaned louder, and fancied that he began to feel pain in the toe. No result from Sid.

Tom was **panting** with his **exertions** by this time. He took a rest and then swelled himself up and fetched a succession of admirable groans. Sid snored on. Tom was **aggravated**. He said, "Sid, Sid!" and shook him. This course worked well, and Tom began to groan again. Sid yawned, stretched, then brought himself up on his elbow with a **snort**, and began to stare at Tom. Tom went on groaning.

Sid said:"Tom! Say, Tom!" [No response.] "Here, TOM! What is the matter, Tom? And he shook him and looked in his face **anxiously**. Tom moaned out: "Oh, don't, Sid. Don't shake me." "Why, what's the matter, Tom? I must call auntie." "No-------never mind. It'll be over by and by, maybe. Don't call anybody."

"But I must! Don't groan so, Tom, it's awful. How long you been this way?" "Hours. Ouch! Oh, don't stir so, Sid, you'll kill me."

"Tom, why didn't you wake me sooner? Oh, Tom, DON'T! It makes my flesh crawl to hear you. What is the matter?"

"I forgive you for everything, Sid. [Groan.] Everything you've ever done to me. When I'm gone--------"

"Oh, Tom, you aren't dying, are you? Don't Tom----------oh, don't. Maybe----------"

"I forgive everybody, Sid. [Groan.] Tell 'em so, Sid. And Sid, you give my window-sash and my cat with one eye to that new girl that's come to town, and tell her-------"

But Sid had snatched his clothes and gone. Tom was suffering in reality, now, his imagination was working well, and so his groans had gathered quite a genuine tone.

Sid flew down-stairs and said:

"Oh, Aunt Polly, come! Tom's dying!"

"Dying!"

"Yes'm. Don't wait. Come quick!"

"Rubbish! I don't believe it!"

But she fled upstairs, nevertheless, with Sid and Mary at her heels. And her face

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